Access to Healthcare

In high school in Littleton, Colorado, Ally Baumgart had a strong interest in math and science. As college approached, she ultimately decided to purse engineering. Ally began her college experience in the Bioengineering program at the University of Colorado, Denver. She then transferred to Colorado State University and graduated with dual bachelor degrees in Biomedical Engineering and Mechanical Engineering.

Currently, Ally is enjoying her role as New Product Development Quality Engineer for CONMED. The work she performs is important because it provides healthcare professionals with tools to perform minimally invasive surgeries. Every surgical device that she designs and develops is intended to improve surgical outcomes for patients around the world. Ally says, “Access to healthcare is a basic human need, and knowing that my work could be improving the life of even just one person motivates me each day to perform at my highest caliber.”

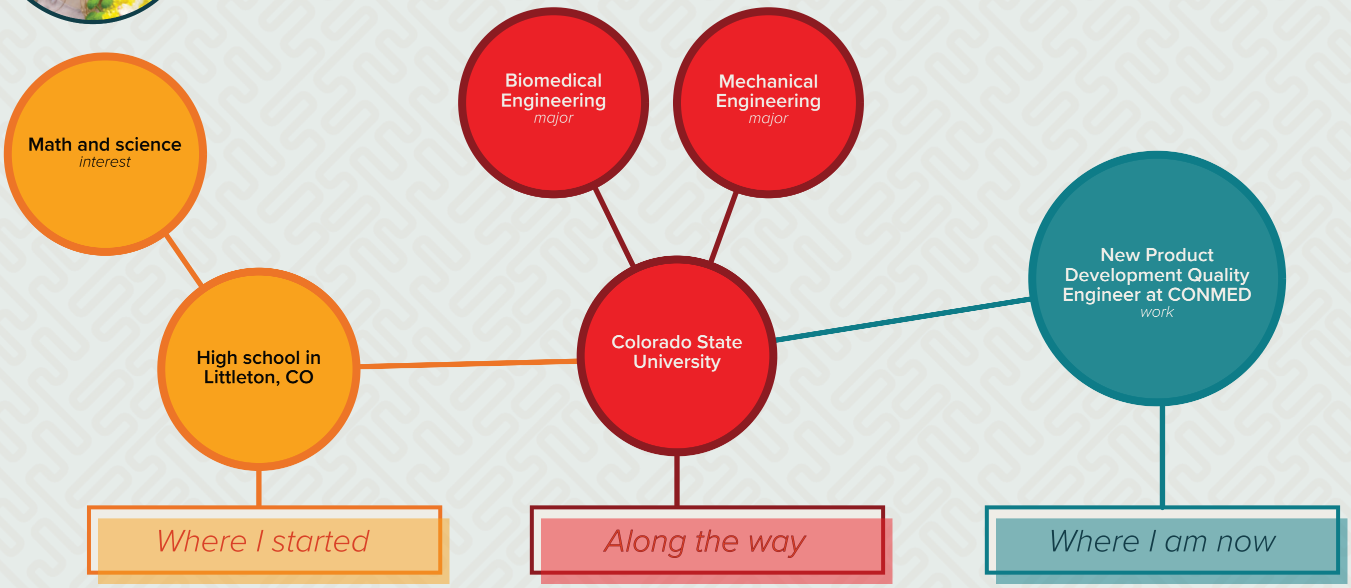
A significant project Ally is working on now is helping to design and develop a state-of-the-art electrosurgical generator (ESU). This ESU will be used to cut and coagulate tissue during surgical procedures as well seal and cut blood vessels. The ESU includes numerous specialty modes and ranges of power settings that provide the surgeon with varying clinical tissue effects, the ability to create and store user programs with preferred modes and settings, and the ability to electrically communicate with other CONMED surgical equipment. During this project, she has attended in-vivo (taking place in a living organism) pig and cadaver labs to better understand the different clinical effects and surgical techniques, conducted usability studies with surgeons and operating room nurses to observe their use of the product, and developed test protocols to evaluate the device functionality.

Engineers Changing the World

Allison Baumgart

New Product Development Quality Engineer, CONMED

“I love my job because I know that I am making a difference in the world and bettering the lives of people just like myself, and I love the challenge and creativity that engineering brings.”



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